

INDUSTRIES

The Centre will spend Rs 5 lakh crore on infrastructure in the next five years. Will it go where it is meant to?

PRITHVIRAJ CHAVAN

Minister of State in the PMO, for Personnel and Public Grievances, Science and Technology, Parliamentary Affairs, Earth Sciences

Trusted Consigliere

The affable Chavan did not want a second stint in the PMO in the UPA II but his quiet diplomacy and discretion have made him an irreplaceable link between 10 Janpath and the PMO. In fact, his earnest look is his biggest asset. This is one reason why the prime minister always fields him on the nuclear question in Parliament as Chavan's genial smile carries him through the Opposition fire.



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Achievements

I Juggled portfolios to get the right numbers on the recent cut motions against the Budget.

I Managed to introduce the critical Nuclear Liability Bill in the Lok Sabha. He was part of the negotiations team that ensured the Yadavs' support.

Failures

I He could not achieve parliamentary consensus on political hot potatoes such as the Women's Reservation Bill in the Lok Sabha and amendments to the land acquisition and rehabilitation bills.

I Despite efforts and his personal attention, India is yet to create a model for an accurate Met forecast for monsoons.

Reality Check

When he tried to juggle two TV sets with one remote. Gave a rueful grin and said, "And I am supposed to be the minister for technology!"

▼ 53%

**Delivery
Meter**

FLOP	MEDIOCRE	GOOD
0-33%	34-64%	65-100%

MURLI DEORA

Minister of Petroleum and Natural Gas

On Slippery Turf

Once a free market activist, Deora has seemingly turned into a social-ist in office. Almost a year went in battling in court to establish sovereign ownership of the RIL KG 6 gas. Despite recommendations, critical reforms on dismantling the administered price regime, cutting subsidies are still pending.



Yet to Achieve

Dual pricing of petrol which remains caught between several committees and varying versions.

▼ 34%

G.K. VASAN

Minister of Shipping

The Helmsman

Vasan has tried to steer the ministry, which was adrift in the tenure of his predecessor T.R. Baalu, out of troubled waters. Traffic at major ports has increased. But decisions are delayed and major ports are headless.



Marquee Moment

Inauguration of India's first global hub terminal, International Container Transshipment Terminal in Kochi in August.

▼ 33%